

The dashboard *Trends in US Violent and Property Crime, 1960-2022* describes the temporal changes in crime trends within the USA during the period. Using the FBI Uniform Crime Reporting Database's collection of various crimes rates from across local precincts, which were rated to a per 100,000 basis, three visualizations were created to provide a regional and type breakdown of crime trends. First, A line chart was created to show changes in murder rate by region. Then, an interactive scatter plot was made to compare violent crime with property crime over time. Lastly, a focus was placed on various types of property crimes in Florida, with a stacked bar chart showing comparable statistics to the overall national trend.

The line chart utilizes the measures murder rate and region. The diagram compares these two measures over the 1960–2022-time span. The murder rate, rated to a per 100,000 basis, reflects the differing rate of crime between different regions in the US. The South tops the national comparison in murder rate, and the Northeast carries the lowest murder rate over most of the period. For the two other regions, while initially murder was higher in the US West, eventually it was superseded by the Midwest. A special point of note is the Supreme Court moratorium on capital punishment between 1972-1976, as shown in the reference band (Bomboy, 2023).

Although the chart suggests that crime peaked then fell during the period, research shows that the effect was likely minimal. On one hand, researchers argue that increased executions may have deterred crime because of the deterrence effect, where fear for the punishment leading to death stops individuals from committing crime (Shephard,2005). On the other hand, with data from the moratorium Leamer found in 1983 that executions drove an increase in violent crime due to the brutalization effect, where the state legitimizes violent behavior by itself executing individuals, driving an uptick in crime. That explains both why crime instead peaked during the moratorium and decreased both during and far after the national ban on capital punishment.

The interactive scatter plot describes the change in both violent and property crime in all US states, over time. Each state, represented by a diamond, was sized based on its population and colored based on the region. The chart is made interactive through a “By Year” time tool which allowed both over-time trend plays and selection of specific years. The chart shows that crime uniformly increased until 1980 in most states and then decreased up until the most recent year of data collection. Research attributes the sudden decrease in crime to legalized abortion and a decrease in teen pregnancies. Less individuals born under crime-driving impoverishment and neglect from circumstances leading to abortions or teen pregnancies. This likely decreased occurrences of crime (Donohue & Levitt, 2001). However, a Pew report that summarizes trends in crime describe individuals across the nation still believed that crime was rising across the nation, except in their area (Gramlich, 2024). The finding matches the scatter plot’s description of a general decrease in crime in all states up until 2022, corresponding perceptions of local crime decreasing but contradicting the perception of rising crime nationally.

Lastly, a stacked bar chart focuses on Florida to dissect the different types of property crimes commonly committed. The stacked bar chart reflects national trends in property crime, with two peaks around 1980 and 1990. Compared nationally Florida generally lies in the top quartile of states for property crime. Broken down by type, Larceny, or theft of personal property, occurred more than all other crimes combined. It was followed by burglary, or unlawful entry into properties for the purpose of crime, and then vehicle theft. It is of note that data is likely distorted by differing reporting rates. For example, 88% of car thefts were often reported while only 44% of burglaries were. The discrepancy is in part because police place low level of significance in solving lower-value burglaries, leading to less individuals reporting (Gramlich, 2024). Due to the reliance of the data source on the Uniform Crime Reporting System, which relies on police data-

it may be distorted to show comparatively more violent crime out of total occurrences (Federal Bureau of Investigation, 2023).

In conclusion, national crime increased in all forms during the 1980s and 1990s and then decreased in part due to less unwanted pregnancies. The visualization also reflects how punishment likely had discharging effects on murder- which is demonstrated by how murder rates both peaked and began to decline during the moratorium. There are many different types of crimes that are committed, It Is important to note that because of different clearing rates and reporting rates, some crimes may appear to be less prevalent than they appear to be.

Appendix

References

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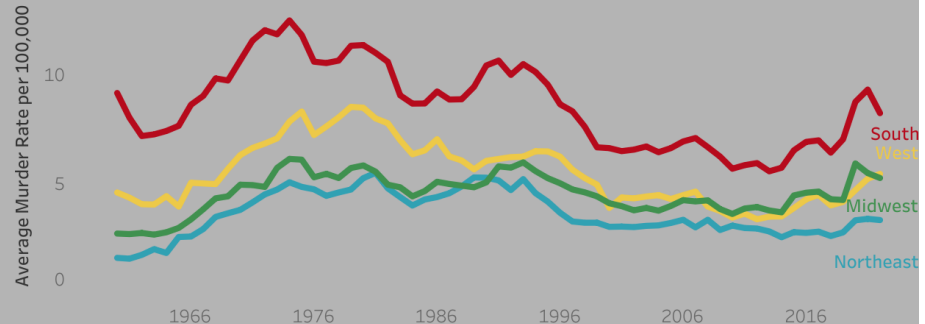
Dashboard

Trends in US Violent and Property Crime

Murder Rate by Region, 1960-2022



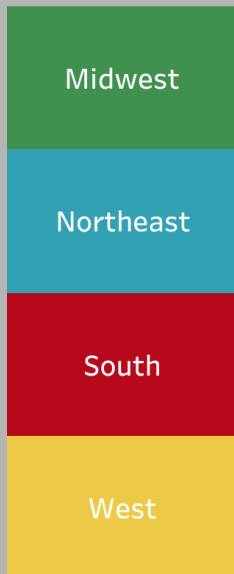
Data from the FBI [Uniform Crime Reporting Database](#)



Above is a line chart denoting the changing average murder rates per 100,000 in each of America's regions. The grey band represents the Supreme Court moratorium on capital punishment.

To the right, a scatter plot showing overall violent crime and property crime by state. Toggle the time player to see changes in crime rates over the years.

Highlight a Region

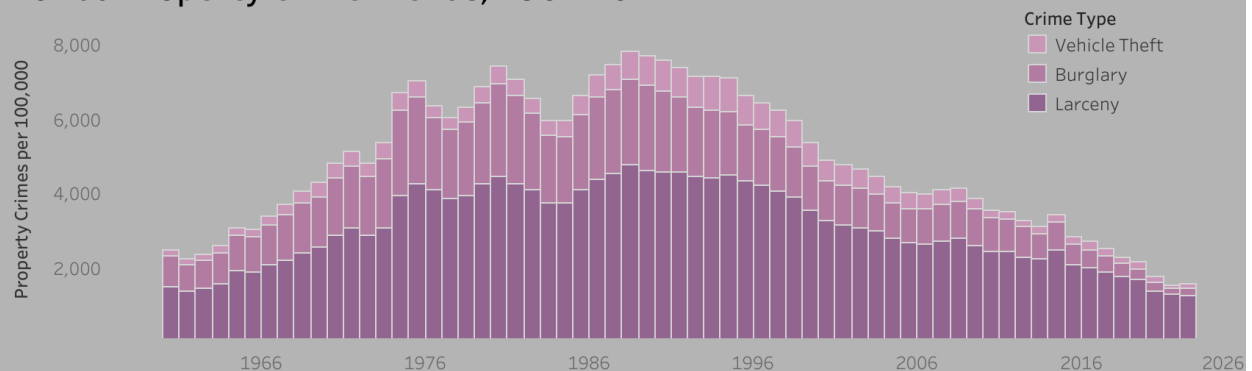


Property Crime vs Violent Crime by State in 1981



Below, a further dissection into property crime trends and types in the State of Florida. Each part of the stacked chart is a type of property crime, denoted in legend.

Florida Property Crime Trends, 1961-2022



Author's Statement

No AI was used in the composition or creation of this write-up.